

Comparator Model by Mechanism

School-Authorized Demand/Supply Formation, Category Control, and Pathway Abandonment

Prepared for Stacey Kahns-Gray | June 2026

Use rule: compare by mechanism, not by identical facts. External sources support the architecture; they do not replace it.

Core lock: A child-facing institution cannot adultify children for participation, expand control over the pathway, extract institutional or stakeholder value, and then abandon male and female children when harm returns.

Working pathway name: school-authorized demand/supply formation and abandonment.

Owner function: public child-protection ownership of demand-side formation and supply-side conversion before harm returns.

Wrong absorbing boxes: career readiness, CTE, entrepreneurship, digital citizenship, media literacy, student voice, personal branding, consent/media release, bullying, discipline, mental health, platform harm only, Title IX-only framing, culture war, advocacy, trauma story.

Internal architecture sources used: Stakeholder Category Control; Rebuilt Case Floor; Baseline Condition Failure + Institutional Neutrality; Child Exploitation Through Unowned Child Supply; Governing Condition - Foreseeability; Category Control Protection; Inside the Machine - Operational Mechanisms.

1. Model Architecture

Comparator unit. The comparator is not factual sameness. The comparator is the recurring institutional mechanism: a known child-facing risk is renamed as opportunity, routed through school or public authority, converted into value, left without an owner, and then returned to the child or family as individual consequence.

Functional pathway. known risk -> sanitized entry language -> adultification or reward loop -> institutional/stakeholder value -> credibility/pathway stripping -> produced absence -> burden transfer -> defense -> delayed or absent abatement.

Step	Mechanism	Test question
1	Known pathway or risk	Risk exists before the child is placed into the condition.
2	Sanitized entry category	The pathway enters as opportunity, prevention, career readiness, digital skill, student voice, leadership, or empowerment.
3	Adultification and reward	The child is treated as mature enough for visibility, demand, branding, judgment, spending, public identity, or market-facing behavior.
4	Control expansion	The school or public actor controls access, framing, records, reporting, category, and continuation.
5	Value conversion	The child supplies attention, data, visibility, legitimacy, content, branding, demand, or future market participation.
6	Owner missing	No named pathway owner preserves warnings, alternatives, withdrawal, aggregation, stop authority, or abatement.
7	Credibility stripping	The child report is recoded as lying, drama, overreaction, regret, bad judgment, peer conflict, or mental health.
8	Produced absence	No category creates no record; no record creates no aggregation; no aggregation becomes defense.
9	Burden transfer	Male children are abandoned as dangerous or misogynist after demand formation; female children are abandoned as attention-seeking or responsible after supply conversion.
10	Abatement failure	The pathway remains available because the institution corrects incidents, not the structure.

2. Core Rule

Future demand money cannot be treated as a career path. A career path prepares a child for protected future agency. A future-demand-money pathway prepares a market to extract from the child later.

Prevention controlled by the demand owner is not prevention. The stakeholder that profits from future demand cannot own the school prevention category.

Respectability language does not erase sexualized visibility risk. Acting, media, branding, portfolios, and public-facing identity must be separated from institutional use of the child as value.

If it walks like grooming function, name the function. The question is not whether one predator used a private script. The question is whether the institution adultified the child, suppressed protective resistance, extracted value, and abandoned the child at consequence.

Calling female children liars is not an insult category. It is a credibility-stripping function that destroys the reporting channel before records can form.

3. Comparator Index

Comparator	Transferable mechanism	Owner function	Wrong box
Tobacco prevention in schools	Prevention-as-access demand preservation	Public-health prevention independent from the industry that profits from future users	Health class / corporate responsibility / prevention curriculum
Boy Scouts / Scouting America	Institutional legitimacy before harmed-child pathway ownership	Child-safety ownership by the institution controlling access and adult authority	Individual offender / old incidents / youth organization failure
Child labor	Adult-controlled child value production requires limits	Labor and safety protection before child work compromises education, health, or development	Work ethic / career readiness / student opportunity
Child performers / Coogan logic	Child performance, image, likeness, and earnings require adult-side protection	Child-performance value protection, records, limits, earnings preservation	Talent / family choice / entertainment
Child influencers / kidfluencers	Child visibility becomes monetized value before child ownership catches up	Online child visibility/value conversion ownership and trust/record duties	Family content / sharenting / creator economy
School commercialism	School access converts children into marketing, research, legitimacy, or consumption value	School gatekeeping before commercial access to students	Partnership / sponsorship / real-world learning
COPPA / ed-tech	School consent cannot cover unrelated commercial value	Educational-purpose limitation and child data protection	Technology use / vendor service / digital learning
PPRA / marketing surveys	Student information is not freely extractable through school access	Notice, review, consent/opt-out, and marketing-use control	Survey / feedback / student voice
IRB / Subpart D	Safeguards belong before minors are placed into exposure conditions	Pre-authorization risk review, consent/assent, monitoring, and records	Research ethics only / not school assignments
Female acting / stage history	Female public visibility can be sexualized even when later professionalized	Female-child visibility protection when performance, image, or branding is school-authorized	Performing arts / AME / creative expression / portfolio
School social-media lawsuits	Schools named children as vulnerable to attention, engagement, and targeting when suing outward	Demand-side child-protection ownership before analogous pathways are authorized inward	Platform harm only / screen time / mental health
Future demand money	Stakeholders train or preserve children as future users, spenders, subscribers, consumers, or sexualized demand	Distinguish child career preparation from child demand production	Career readiness / entrepreneurship / marketing / financial literacy
Institutional grooming-function	Child feels adult enough to enter, then carries adult consequences after harm returns	Ownership of adultification, boundary suppression, control expansion, and abandonment	Empowerment / maturity / student choice / leadership
Female-child liar label	Disbelief strips the report before the pathway can be classified, recorded, or aggregated	Credibility preservation at first report, first fear, first refusal, and first boundary signal	False allegation / drama / attention-seeking / mental health
CTE / student voice / branding / portfolios	School-authorized visibility becomes institutional proof while downstream cost remains individual	School-side pathway ownership before public-facing child identity is produced	Career pathway / student portfolio / leadership / digital citizenship

4. Comparator Cards

1. Tobacco prevention in schools

Pathway name: Prevention-as-access demand-formation pathway

Transferable mechanism: A harmful industry entered schools under prevention language, gained child-facing legitimacy, weakened anti-industry understanding, protected its image, and preserved future demand. The school-facing word was prevention; the transferable mechanism was demand-owner access to the prevention category.

Owner function: Independent public-health and school child-protection ownership of addiction/demand prevention before industry access to children.

Wrong absorbing box: Health education; corporate responsibility; prevention curriculum; youth outreach; school partnership; free materials.

Support block: [S1] CDC evidence brief on tobacco-industry-sponsored school-based youth prevention.

2. Boy Scouts / Scouting America

Pathway name: Institutional-legitimacy without harmed-child pathway ownership

Transferable mechanism: The organization had federal/public legitimacy and a recognized youth-development category while the child-harm pathway remained fragmented until survivor aggregation, litigation, and bankruptcy forced visibility. The transferable lesson is category asymmetry: the institution becomes legible before the harmed-child pathway does.

Owner function: Institutional access-control and child-safety pathway ownership by the organization whose adult structure controlled access to children.

Wrong absorbing box: Individual offender; historic incidents; volunteer problem; youth organization failure; bankruptcy administration only.

Support block: [S10] Congressional charter source; [S11] Reuters report on more than 82,000 claims in settlement proceedings.

3. Child labor

Pathway name: Child value-production protection pathway

Transferable mechanism: Public law already rejects the idea that a child becomes an ordinary market actor when adult systems benefit from child work. The value can be labor, time, availability, production, or participation; the protection principle attaches because the worker is a child.

Owner function: Labor, education, and child-safety systems must protect education, health, well-being, and development before work compromises them.

Wrong absorbing box: Work ethic; career readiness; responsibility; student opportunity; employability skills.

Support block: [S2] U.S. Department of Labor FLSA youth-employment fact sheet.

4. Child performers / Coogan logic

Pathway name: Child image/performance value-protection pathway

Transferable mechanism: Child performers demonstrate that image, likeness, performance, time, and earnings can be converted into adult-controlled value and therefore require trust accounts, records, work limits, and adult-side duties.

Owner function: Child-performance value protection, including earnings preservation, limits, schooling/rest rules, record duties, and court or agency oversight where applicable.

Wrong absorbing box: Talent; family choice; entertainment; creative opportunity; portfolio building.

Support block: [S8] California Coogan Trust Account statute; [S9] Illinois child-performer trust and work-hour rules.

5. Child influencers / kidfluencers

Pathway name: Online child visibility/value conversion pathway

Transferable mechanism: The child influencer branch proves that child likeness, name, photograph, personality, and recurring visibility can produce compensable value. The child does not become less vulnerable because value is produced through content rather than a factory or stage.

Owner function: Online child visibility/value conversion ownership, including records, trust funds, future rights, and adult-side responsibility.

Wrong absorbing box: Family content; sharenting; cute videos; creator economy; parent choice; private family matter.

Support block: [S7] Illinois child-vlogging bill requiring set-aside of gross earnings in trust for the minor.

6. School commercialism

Pathway name: Commercial access through public school authority

Transferable mechanism: Public schools are not neutral market locations. When commercial actors enter through school structures, the student can become advertising surface, research source, audience, data source, brand carrier, or legitimacy proof.

Owner function: School gatekeeping before commercial access to students, including approval, limits, notice, independence, and conflict review.

Wrong absorbing box: Partnership; sponsorship; innovation; community connection; real-world learning; free resources.

Support block: [S5] GAO report scope on laws, policies, nature, and extent of commercial activities in public schools.

7. COPPA / ed-tech commercial-purpose boundary

Pathway name: Educational-purpose limitation pathway

Transferable mechanism: School consent has a boundary: it can support school-authorized educational use, not unrelated commercial use. The transferable rule is that school authority cannot launder child value into commercial pathways merely by calling the access educational.

Owner function: Child data protection and educational-purpose limitation before vendor access or commercial profiling occurs.

Wrong absorbing box: Technology use; digital learning; vendor service; school-approved app; personalization.

Support block: [S3] FTC COPPA guidance for ed-tech and schools.

8. PPRA / marketing surveys

Pathway name: Student-information extraction control pathway

Transferable mechanism: Student information and attitudes are not freely extractable just because the child is inside school. The existence of PPRA supports the principle that school-facilitated collection for marketing or sensitive purposes requires a protection layer.

Owner function: Parent/student notice, review, consent or opt-out, and marketing-use control.

Wrong absorbing box: Survey; feedback; student voice; needs assessment; program improvement.

Support block: [S6] U.S. Department of Education PPRA overview.

9. IRB / Subpart D child research protections

Pathway name: Pre-authorization minor-exposure review pathway

Transferable mechanism: If minors are placed into research exposure conditions, the adult system must name the activity, assess risk, structure consent/assent, preserve oversight, and justify exposure before the child is placed into the condition. The timing is the lesson: safeguards come before exposure.

Owner function: Pre-authorization risk review, vulnerability assessment, minimization, consent/assent, monitoring, and records for minors.

Wrong absorbing box: Research ethics only; ordinary school assignment; classroom innovation; pilot program.

Support block: [S4] HHS Common Rule Subpart D for children involved as subjects in research.

10. Female acting / stage history

Pathway name: Sexualized-performance respectability conversion pathway

Transferable mechanism: Female public performance was historically treated as sexually suspect even as acting became professionalized and respectable. The transferable lesson is not that acting is exploitation; it is that public female visibility can be converted by audiences into sexualized interpretation, reputation attachment, and moral classification.

Owner function: Protection of female children and child performers when school-authorized performance, media, image, branding, or public identity creates foreseeable sexualized interpretation or value conversion.

Wrong absorbing box: Performing arts; AME; creative expression; theatre tradition; career readiness; student portfolio; media release.

Support block: [S12] Cambridge Theatre Research International article on actresses and prostitutes in Victorian London.

11. School social-media lawsuits

Pathway name: Demand-side notice mirror

Transferable mechanism: When schools sue platforms, they name children as vulnerable consumers, attention targets, and users harmed by targeting and addictive environments. That naming creates a mirror: if schools then authorize analogous attention, visibility, branding, and engagement pathways inward, they cannot deny the child-protection issue at the school side.

Owner function: Demand-side child-protection ownership before attention, engagement, visibility, and platform-like reward pathways are normalized through school authority.

Wrong absorbing box: Platform harm only; screen time; mental health; outside-school problem; resources claim only.

Support block: [S13] Seattle Public Schools statement on its social-media complaint.

12. Future demand money

Pathway name: Demand-side market formation disguised as career readiness

Transferable mechanism: A school cannot call a pathway career readiness when the operative value is the formation, preservation, or monetization of future demand. The child is not being prepared for protected future agency; the market is being prepared to extract from the child as future user, spender, subscriber, status participant, platform participant, or sexualized demand.

Owner function: The career-readiness owner must distinguish child career preparation from child demand production before the pathway reaches the child.

Wrong absorbing box: Career readiness; entrepreneurship; marketing; financial literacy; creator economy; digital citizenship; student voice; personal branding.

Support block: [S1] tobacco prevention comparator; [S13] demand-side social-media lawsuit mirror.

13. Institutional grooming-function

Pathway name: School-authorized grooming-function pathway through adultification, control expansion, and abandonment

Transferable mechanism: Use grooming as a function comparator: the child is made to feel adult, special, capable, trusted, empowered, mature, or future-ready; protective resistance is suppressed; adult/institutional control expands; participation produces value; and the child carries adult consequences when harm returns. The model does not require proving one individual predator intent. It identifies an institutional function.

Owner function: Public child-protection ownership of adultification, boundary suppression, demand formation, supply conversion, and pathway abandonment under school authority.

Wrong absorbing box: Empowerment; maturity; leadership; student choice; confidence-building; career readiness; digital citizenship.

Support block: [S14] NSPCC grooming guidance that grooming can involve people known to a child, including professionals, and can prepare children for exploitation.

14. Female-child liar label

Pathway name: Female-child credibility-stripping pathway

Transferable mechanism: Calling female children liars is not merely an insult. It is a reporting-channel destruction move. It attacks perception, motive, memory, fear, refusal, boundary, report, and future credibility. Once the report is recoded as lie, drama, regret, or attention-seeking, the pathway is not classified correctly, records do not form, aggregation fails, and the absence later becomes defense.

Owner function: Child-protection credibility preservation at first report, first fear, first refusal, first discomfort, and first boundary signal.

Wrong absorbing box: False allegation; drama; attention-seeking; mental health; peer conflict; bad judgment; reputation; proof problem.

Support block: [S14] grooming/safeguarding context; internal architecture sources on child incapacity to force category and produced absence.

15. CTE / student voice / branding / portfolios

Pathway name: School-authorized visibility/value conversion pathway

Transferable mechanism: This is the K-12 execution box. It is not wrong because children learn digital or professional skills. It becomes the pathway when school authority converts child identity, image, visibility,

branding, student voice, online presence, or market-facing self-presentation into institutional/stakeholder value without owner, warning, refusal, withdrawal, aggregation, or abatement.

Owner function: School-side pathway ownership before public-facing child identity is produced, credited, graded, showcased, or stakeholder-shaped.

Wrong absorbing box: Career pathway; portfolio; student voice; leadership; branding; digital media; employability skill; authentic audience.

Support block: [S3] COPPA educational-purpose boundary; [S5] GAO school commercialism; [S13] school social-media lawsuit mirror.

5. Demand/Supply Child Branch

Male-child demand formation. The male child is not the origin actor. He is a child placed into reward, status, ranking, consumption, entitlement, spending, sexualized demand, and detachment scripts. He may later be recoded as misogynist, unsafe, addicted, dangerous, or offender-like after the demand pathway matures. That is abandonment after formation.

Female-child supply conversion. The female child is not the author of the pathway. She is a child placed into visibility, branding, desirability interpretation, public identity, attention, reputation, and market-facing self-presentation. She may later be recoded as attention-seeking, dramatic, lying, regretful, reputation-damaged, or responsible after visibility becomes sexualized or reputationally harmful. That is abandonment after conversion.

Shared child-protection lock. Both children were used. One was formed into demand. One was converted into supply. Then both were blamed after the pathway matured.

6. Mechanism Test for New Comparators

1. What is the pathway name in functional terms?
2. Who benefits before the child sees the delayed cost?
3. Who controls entry, framing, access, records, reporting, and category?
4. What adult-coded status is offered to the child at entry?
5. What protective instinct, refusal, discomfort, or boundary was suppressed?
6. What child value is produced: attention, visibility, demand, data, legitimacy, content, branding, reputation, or future market participation?
7. What owner function should attach before exposure?
8. What wrong school/legal box would absorb the harm?
9. What record would have formed if the pathway had been correctly named?
10. Who carries the burden when harm returns?
11. What abatement would reduce participation, access, exposure, or stakeholder value?

7. External Source Notes

[S1] CDC, Evidence Brief: Tobacco Industry Sponsored Youth Prevention Programs in Schools. CDC states that tobacco industry-sponsored school-based tobacco prevention programs are ineffective and may

promote youth tobacco use; CDC also encourages prevention efforts to remain independent of tobacco-industry influence. https://archive.cdc.gov/www_cdc.gov/tobacco/basic_information/youth/evidence-brief/index.htm

[S2] U.S. Department of Labor, Fact Sheet #43 - Child Labor Provisions of the FLSA. DOL explains that youth-employment provisions are intended to ensure work does not jeopardize young people's health, well-being, or educational opportunities. <https://www.dol.gov/agencies/whd/fact-sheets/43-child-labor-non-agriculture>

[S3] Federal Trade Commission, COPPA Guidance for Ed Tech Companies and Schools. FTC states that schools can consent for collection of student personal information only for a school-authorized educational purpose and for no other commercial purpose. <https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/blog/2020/04/coppa-guidance-ed-tech-companies-schools-during-coronavirus>

[S4] HHS/OHRP, 45 CFR 46 Subpart D - Additional Protections for Children Involved as Subjects in Research. Subpart D applies to research involving children as subjects and contains additional protections for children. <https://www.hhs.gov/ohrp/regulations-and-policy/regulations/45-cfr-46/common-rule-subpart-d/index.html>

[S5] U.S. GAO, Public Education: Commercial Activities in Schools. GAO studied laws, regulations, policies, and the nature and extent of commercial activities in public schools. <https://www.gao.gov/products/hehs-00-156>

[S6] U.S. Department of Education, What is the Protection of Pupil Rights Amendment (PPRA)? ED describes PPRA as concerning marketing surveys, student privacy, parental access, and certain physical examinations of minors. <https://studentprivacy.ed.gov/faq/what-protection-pupil-rights-amendment-ppra>

[S7] Illinois General Assembly, SB1782. Illinois child-vlogging legislation required a vlogger featuring a minor child in specified compensated online content to set aside gross earnings in a trust account for the minor. <https://www.ilga.gov/ftp/legislation/103/SB/10300SB1782.htm>

[S8] California Family Code section 6753, Coogan Trust Account. California law requires a Coogan Trust Account to preserve a portion of a minor's gross earnings under covered contracts. <https://law.justia.com/codes/california/code-fam/division-11/part-3/chapter-3/section-6753/>

[S9] Illinois DCEO, Child Labor Laws - Filming in Illinois. Illinois child performer rules include trust-fund and time/schooling/rest requirements for minors in entertainment-related performances. <https://dceo.illinois.gov/whyillinois/film/filminginillinois/childlaborlaws.html>

[S10] 36 U.S.C. Chapter 309, Boy Scouts of America. Federal law states that Boy Scouts of America is federally chartered and sets out its purposes. <https://uscode.house.gov/view.xhtml?edition=prelim&path=%2Fprelim%40title36%2Fsubtitle2%2FpartB%2Fchapter309>

[S11] Reuters, U.S. Supreme Court lets \$2.46 billion Boy Scouts sex abuse settlement proceed. Reuters reported that the settlement involved more than 82,000 men who said they were abused as children in Boy Scouts. <https://www.reuters.com/legal/us-supreme-court-lets-246-billion-boy-scouts-sex-abuse-settlement-proceed-2024-02-22/>

[S12] Cambridge Core, Actresses and Prostitutes in Victorian London. The article states that popular association between actresses and prostitutes and belief in actresses' inappropriate sexual conduct endured through the nineteenth century. <https://www.cambridge.org/core/journals/theatre-research-international/article/abs/actresses-and-prostitutes-in-victorian-london/6843E08D4F0DDFAFAEEEAABF98B57F90>

[S13] Seattle Public Schools, Social Media Complaint Filed by Seattle Public Schools. SPS stated that it sued companies operating TikTok, Instagram, Facebook, Snapchat, and YouTube and described young people as vulnerable consumers harmed by the platforms' practices. <https://www.seattleschools.org/news/social-media-case/>

[S14] NSPCC Learning, Grooming: recognising the signs. NSPCC states that grooming can be done by someone a child knows, including a professional, and can prepare children for sexual abuse and exploitation, radicalisation, or criminal exploitation. <https://learning.nspcc.org.uk/safeguarding-child-protection/grooming>

8. Final Lock

- The comparator is mechanism, not identical conduct.
- The owner function attaches before exposure, not after harm returns.
- Future demand money is stakeholder value projected into the child's future, not a student career path.
- A prevention category controlled by the demand owner preserves the pathway it claims to prevent.
- A liar label applied to female children is not mere insult; it is pathway erasure by credibility stripping.
- If the institution made refusal costly, it cannot later call participation free choice.
- If the institution controlled the category and record, absence cannot be treated as neutral absence.
- No institutional ownership means no lawful child pathway.